Leave Policy

Kestrel Ridge Technologies Ltd.

Document ID	Version	Effective date	Policy owner	Next review
HR-POL-004	3.1	1 April 2026	Head of Human Resources	31 March 2027

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 This policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Kestrel Ridge Technologies Ltd. (the "Company"), how leave is earned, and how to apply for it.

1.2 The policy applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees in all Company offices. Interns and contractors are covered only by Section 9 (Public Holidays) unless their contract states otherwise.

2. Definitions

- **Leave year:** 1 January to 31 December.
- **Working day:** Monday to Friday, excluding public holidays.
- **Probation period:** the first 6 months of employment.
- **Immediate family:** spouse or partner, children, parents, siblings and parents-in-law.
- **HRConnect:** the Company's online HR portal used to apply for and approve leave.

3. Leave Entitlements

3.1 Full-time employees are entitled to the following leave in each leave year. Part-time employees receive leave in proportion to their contracted hours.

Leave type	Entitlement per year	Carry forward	Advance notice required
Earned (annual) leave	18 working days	Up to 10 days	7 days; 14 days for 4 or more consecutive days
Sick leave	10 working days	Not allowed	Inform manager before 10:00 on the first day
Casual leave	6 working days	Not allowed	1 working day
Maternity leave	26 weeks (paid)	Not applicable	8 weeks before expected date
Paternity leave	10 working days	Not applicable	4 weeks before expected date
Bereavement leave	5 working days per event	Not applicable	As soon as possible
Marriage leave	3 working days (once during employment)	Not applicable	30 days

3.2 Paternity leave must be taken within 3 months of the birth or adoption of the child.

3.3 Casual leave may not be taken for more than 2 consecutive days and may not be combined with earned leave.

4. Accrual and Probation

4.1 Earned leave accrues at 1.5 days for each completed month of service. Employees joining part-way through the year receive a pro-rated entitlement.

4.2 During the probation period an employee may take a maximum of 3 days of earned leave. Sick leave and casual leave are available from the first day of employment.

4.3 Additional leave for long service

Employees receive additional earned leave based on completed years of service on 1 January of each leave year:

Completed years of service	Additional earned leave per year	Total earned leave
0 - 2 years	0 days	18 days
3 - 5 years	2 days	20 days
6 - 10 years	4 days	22 days
More than 10 years	6 days	24 days

5. Applying for Leave

5.1 All leave must be applied for in HRConnect. The reporting manager must approve or reject the request within 2 working days. Requests not actioned in 2 working days are escalated automatically to the department head.

5.2 Emergency leave: if an employee cannot apply in advance because of an emergency, they must inform their manager by phone or message on the same day and apply in HRConnect within 2 working days of returning to work.

5.3 Leave taken without approval is treated as unauthorised absence and may lead to loss of pay and disciplinary action.

6. Sick Leave

6.1 A medical certificate from a registered doctor is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive working days. The certificate must be uploaded in HRConnect within 3 working days of returning to work.

6.2 If sick leave is exhausted, further absence due to illness is deducted from earned leave, and then treated as leave without pay.

6.3 Sick leave cannot be encashed and lapses at the end of the leave year.

7. Carry Forward and Encashment

7.1 A maximum of 10 unused earned leave days may be carried forward to the next leave year. Carried-forward days must be used by 31 March of the next year; any unused carried-forward days lapse after that date.

7.2 Earned leave cannot be encashed while in employment. On resignation or retirement, unused earned leave up to a maximum of 30 days is paid out at the employee's basic salary rate.

7.3 Employees dismissed for misconduct are not eligible for leave encashment.

8. Leave Without Pay and Sabbatical

8.1 Leave without pay (LWP) of up to 30 days per year may be granted by the department head, but only after all earned leave has been used.

8.2 Employees with at least 5 years of continuous service may apply for an unpaid sabbatical of up to 3 months. A sabbatical requires approval from the department head and the HR Director, and must be requested at least 60 days in advance.

9. Public Holidays

9.1 The Company observes 10 fixed public holidays each year. The list for the next year is published by HR in December.

9.2 In addition, each employee may choose 2 optional holidays from the published optional holiday list.

9.3 Employees required to work on a public holiday receive a compensatory day off, which must be taken within 30 days.

10. Special Leave

10.1 The following paid special leave is available in addition to the entitlements in Section 3. It does not reduce earned, sick or casual leave balances.

Situation	Paid leave allowed	Evidence required
Jury duty or court witness	As long as required by the court	Court summons
Voting in a national or state election	1 day (polling day)	None
Blood or platelet donation	Half a day per donation, maximum 4 per year	Donation certificate
Serious illness of an immediate family member	Up to 5 days per year	Medical letter
Relocation at the Company's request	2 days	Transfer letter

11. Leave During the Notice Period

11.1 Earned leave may not be taken during the notice period unless approved in writing by the department head. Approved leave does not extend the last working day.

11.2 Sick leave may be taken during the notice period, but a medical certificate is required for every day of sick leave.

12. Return to Work

12.1 After sick leave of more than 10 consecutive working days, the employee must submit a fitness-to-work certificate before returning.

12.2 Employees returning from long illness, maternity leave or a sabbatical may request a phased return of up to 4 weeks with reduced hours, agreed with their manager and HR.

13. Worked Examples

Example 1: Priya joined on 1 April and finished probation on 30 September. By 31 December she has completed 9 months of service and has accrued 13.5 days of earned leave (9 x 1.5). During probation she could use at most 3 of those days.

Example 2: Arjun has 14 unused earned leave days on 31 December. He can carry forward 10 days; the other 4 days lapse. The 10 carried-forward days must be used by 31 March, otherwise they also lapse.

Example 3: Meera is sick for 3 consecutive working days. Because this is more than 2 days, she must upload a medical certificate in HRConnect within 3 working days of returning.

14. Contact

Questions about this policy should be sent to the HR team at hr@kestrelridge.example.

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
2.0	1 April 2024	Added paternity leave and HRConnect portal.
3.0	1 April 2025	Increased maternity leave to 26 weeks; added sabbatical.
3.1	1 April 2026	Added long-service leave table and special leave (Section 10).